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Palace

3.4 Palace

References:

Hebrew אַרְמוֹן (’armon) 1KI 16:18, 2KI 15:25, 2CH 36:19

Hebrew בִּירָה (birah) 1CH 29:1, 1CH 29:19

Hebrew בַּיִת (bayith) GEN 12:15, GEN 12:17, GEN 41:40, GEN 45:2, GEN 45:8, GEN 45:16, GEN 47:14, GEN 50:4

Hebrew בֵּית מֶלֶךְ (beyth (ha)melek) 2SA 11:2, 2SA 11:8, 2SA 11:9, 2SA 15:35, 1KI 9:1, 1KI 9:10, 1KI 10:12, 1KI 14:26, 1KI 14:27, 1KI 15:18, 1KI 16:18, 1KI 16:18, 2KI 11:5, 2KI 11:16, 2KI 11:19, 2KI 11:20, 2KI 12:19, 2KI 14:14, 2KI 15:25, 2KI 16:8, 2KI 18:15, 2KI 24:13, 2KI 25:9, 2CH 7:11, 2CH 8:11, 2CH 9:11, 2CH 12:10, 2CH 16:2, 2CH 21:17, 2CH 23:5, 2CH 23:15, 2CH 23:20, 2CH 25:24, 2CH 28:21, NEH 3:25, EST 2:8, EST 2:9, EST 2:13, EST 4:13, EST 5:1, EST 5:1, EST 6:4, EST 9:4, JER 19:13, JER 21:11, JER 22:1, JER 26:10, JER 27:18, JER 27:21, JER 32:2, JER 33:4, JER 36:12, JER 38:7, JER 38:8, JER 38:11, JER 38:22, JER 39:8, JER 52:13

Hebrew בִּיתָן (bithan) EST 1:5, EST 7:7, EST 7:8

Hebrew הֵיכָל (heykal) 1KI 21:1, 2KI 20:18, 2CH 36:7, PSA 45:9, PSA 45:16, PSA 144:12, PRO 30:28, ISA 13:22, ISA 39:7, DAN 1:4, DAN 4:1, DAN 4:26, JOL 4:5

Aramaic הֵיכַל (heykal) EZR 4:14, DAN 4:1, DAN 4:26, DAN 5:5, DAN 6:19

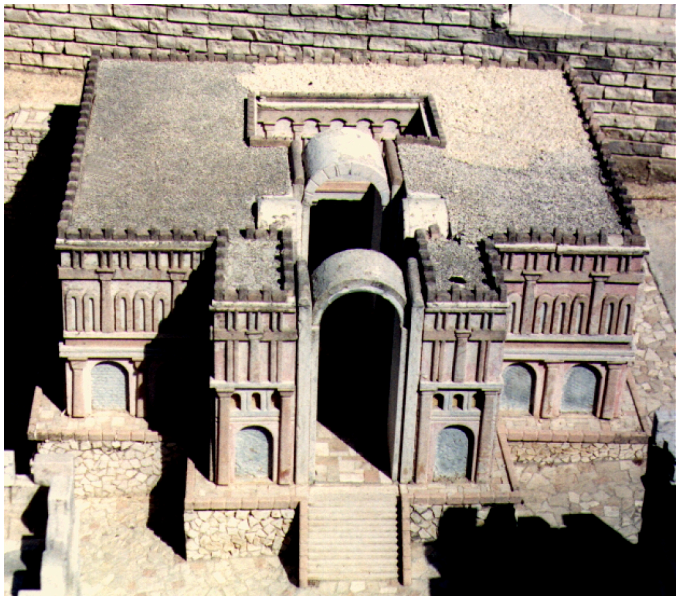
Greek αὐλή (aulē) 1MA 11:46

Greek βασιλεία, βασίλειον, βασίλειος (basileia, basileion, basileios) LUK 7:25, LJE 1:58, 1MA 2:10

Greek οἶκος, βασιλεία, βασιλεύς (oiko (basileias), oikos (basileōs)) MAT 11:8, JDT 2:1, JDT 2:18, JDT 11:23, JDT 12:13, JDT 14:18, 1MA 7:2

Greek πραιτώριον (praitōrion) MAT 27:27, MRK 15:16, JHN 18:28, JHN 18:28, JHN 18:33, JHN 19:9, ACT 23:35, PHP 1:13

Description and usage:



Model of a palace in New Testament times (© Ray Pritz by United Bible Societies)The palace was the dwelling of a king or ruler. Such a dwelling was usually larger and more elaborate than the dwelling of an average person. Its structure and building materials varied widely.

Translation:

"Palace" may be rendered "home of a king" or "home of a ruler."

The Hebrew word *'armon* sometimes indicates the fortified part of a king's residence or other fortified dwellings; see 1KI 16:18. In such cases it will be better to render it as "citadel" or "stronghold." See also 3.13.3.2 Fortress, stronghold, castle, citadel, fort<REALIA:3.13.3.2>.

PSA 45:9: "Ivory palaces" (RSV; see also 1KI 22:39) are not palaces built completely of ivory, but palaces decorated with ivory, either on the building itself or on its furniture (see 1KI 10:18; AMO 3:15; AMO 6:4).

PSA 144:12: The Hebrew word *heykal* can also mean "temple." It is almost always clear which meaning is intended, either from the context or from some modifier such as "of the LORD" or "of the king." However, the meaning in this verse is in doubt; some translations have "palace" (RSV, GNT) while others have "temple" (NAB, NCV).

There are differences of opinion concerning what building in Jerusalem is indicated by the Greek word *praitōrion* in the Gospels. It may have been either the palace of Herod in the western part of the city or the fortress Antonia northwest of the Temple area. The *praitōrion* in Caesarea (ACT 23:35) was the palace built by Herod the Great. In the Gospels it is satisfactory to translate *praitōrion* as "palace where the governor lived" or "large dwelling where the ruler lived." In some languages the term for "palace" may suggest a military fortification, and this would be quite appropriate for these New Testament passages.